INTERVIEW READINESS ROADMAP

12-Week Standard Interview Roadmap

For candidates balancing preparation with a full-time role at 7-9 focused hours per week

A workload-aware sequence that turns Vault content into practice evidence, checkpoints, and escalation decisions.

VERSION 0.1-PILOT

PACE 7-9 FOCUSED HOURS / WEEK

FORMAT WEEKLY PLAN + CHECKLIST

STATUS HUMAN REVIEW REQUIRED

ROADMAP / 7-9 HOURS PER WEEK

00 START HERE

Who this track is for

- ☐ You want durable pattern mastery rather than a short sprint.
- ☐ Your interview window is at least eight weeks away or still flexible.
- ☐ You can protect four focused sessions each week.

OPERATING RULE

Use the diagnostic to move effort between DSA, system design, and behavioral work; do not add hours blindly.

PAID-TIER DISCLOSURE

AI Prep and 1:1 Premium are paid upgrades and are not included in the Vault.

Score the same six dimensions

Dimension	Weekly evidence
Problem recognition	0 = blocked | 1 = inconsistent | 2 = reliable
Correctness and edge cases	0 = blocked | 1 = inconsistent | 2 = reliable
Complexity explanation	0 = blocked | 1 = inconsistent | 2 = reliable
System design structure	0 = blocked | 1 = inconsistent | 2 = reliable
Behavioral evidence	0 = blocked | 1 = inconsistent | 2 = reliable
Communication under time pressure	0 = blocked | 1 = inconsistent | 2 = reliable

W01 WEEKLY FLIGHT PLAN

Baseline and operating system

Vault route

PDF	operations_study-planning.pdf
PDF	operations_error-log.pdf
TEMPLATE	template_weekly-prep-tracker.docx
TEMPLATE	template_behavioral-story-bank.docx

Practice targets

- [ ] Run one mixed DSA diagnostic and one 30-minute design diagnostic.
- [ ] Create an error log with cue, wrong assumption, fix, and revisit date.
- [ ] Draft six raw career stories without polishing them.

Checkpoint self-assessment

- [ ] Do you know your weakest two dimensions?
- [ ] Is every study block attached to an observable output?

DECISION RULE

Allocate half of Week 2 to the weaker of coding fluency and pattern recognition.

W02 WEEKLY FLIGHT PLAN

Hash maps, prefix sums, and two pointers

Vault route

VIDEO	dsa_hash-maps_01.mp4
VIDEO	dsa_prefix-sum_01.mp4
VIDEO	dsa_two-pointers_01.mp4
PDF	dsa_hash-maps.pdf
PDF	dsa_prefix-sum.pdf
PDF	dsa_two-pointers.pdf

Practice targets

- [ ] Solve 15 problems across the three patterns.
- [ ] Re-solve four misses after a 48-hour gap.
- [ ] Explain the invariant before every second solution.

Checkpoint self-assessment

- [ ] Can you distinguish pair lookup, prefix accumulation, and converging pointers?
- [ ] Is repeat accuracy at least 75 percent?

DECISION RULE

Repeat only the failed pattern ladder; advance the others.

W03 WEEKLY FLIGHT PLAN

Sliding window and binary search

Vault route

VIDEO	dsa_sliding-window_01.mp4
VIDEO	dsa_binary-search_01.mp4
PDF	dsa_sliding-window.pdf
PDF	dsa_binary-search.pdf
PDF	operations_dsa-mock-rubric.pdf

Practice targets

- [ ] Solve 14 problems: 7 sliding window and 7 binary search.
- [ ] Complete one 45-minute DSA mock using the Vault rubric.
- [ ] Review all off-by-one errors as one cluster.

Checkpoint self-assessment

- [ ] Can you state search boundaries and termination before coding?
- [ ] Can you place a variable-window answer update correctly?

PAID CHECKPOINT: AI PREP

You can now solve familiar mediums and need timed, repeatable feedback. Optional paid checkpoint: begin AI Prep mocks from Week 3. AI Prep is not included in the Vault.

DECISION RULE

A mock below threshold is diagnostic data; repair it before booking another.

W04 WEEKLY FLIGHT PLAN

Trees and graph traversal

Vault route

VIDEO	dsa_dfs_01.mp4
VIDEO	dsa_bfs_01.mp4
PDF	dsa_dfs.pdf
PDF	dsa_bfs.pdf
PDF	dsa_topological-sort.pdf

Practice targets

- [ ] Solve 16 traversal problems across trees, grids, and graphs.
- [ ] Write iterative and recursive traversal once each.
- [ ] Practice choosing DFS versus BFS aloud.

Checkpoint self-assessment

- [ ] Can you define visited-state ownership?
- [ ] Can you explain queue or stack space in terms of width or depth?

DECISION RULE

If graph setup causes more errors than traversal, isolate representation and visited-state drills.

W05 WEEKLY FLIGHT PLAN

Backtracking, heaps, intervals, and ordering

Vault route

VIDEO	dsa_backtracking_01.mp4
VIDEO	dsa_heap-priority-queue_01.mp4
VIDEO	dsa_intervals_01.mp4
VIDEO	dsa_topological-sort_01.mp4
PDF	dsa_backtracking.pdf
PDF	dsa_heap-priority-queue.pdf

Practice targets

- [ ] Solve 16 problems across four patterns.
- [ ] For backtracking, label choose, explore, and undo.
- [ ] For heaps and intervals, state the ordering key before implementation.

Checkpoint self-assessment

- [ ] Can you identify when global ordering is cheaper than sorting everything?
- [ ] Do backtracking branches restore state exactly?

DECISION RULE

Keep one weak advanced pattern active next week; park the others after a clean re-solve.

W06 WEEKLY FLIGHT PLAN

Dynamic programming and midpoint calibration

Vault route

VIDEO	dsa_dynamic-programming-1d_01.mp4
VIDEO	dsa_dynamic-programming-2d_01.mp4
PDF	dsa_dynamic-programming-1d.pdf
PDF	dsa_dynamic-programming-2d.pdf
PDF	operations_dsa-mock-rubric.pdf

Practice targets

- [ ] Solve 14 DP problems with state, transition, base case, and order written first.
- [ ] Run a second DSA mock and compare rubric dimensions with Week 3.
- [ ] Re-solve the five highest-cost errors from Weeks 1-5.

Checkpoint self-assessment

- [ ] Can you derive a recurrence without copying a known template?
- [ ] Are AI or rubric-based mock scores improving after repair?

PAID CHECKPOINT: 1:1 PREMIUM

The same rubric dimension remains below threshold after at least two repaired AI mocks, or a high-stakes interview is approaching. If repaired AI mocks are not improving by Week 6, consider a paid 1:1 Premium session focused on the persistent gap. This is optional and capacity-limited.

DECISION RULE

Escalate a persistent root cause, not a single bad score.

W07 WEEKLY FLIGHT PLAN

System design framing and core components

Vault route

VIDEO	sysdesign_load-balancing_01.mp4
VIDEO	sysdesign_caching_01.mp4
VIDEO	sysdesign_api-gateway_01.mp4
PDF	sysdesign_load-balancing.pdf
PDF	sysdesign_caching.pdf
PDF	sysdesign_api-gateway.pdf

Practice targets

- [ ] Write three 35-minute designs with requirements, estimates, API, data, architecture, and bottlenecks.
- [ ] Defend one alternative for every major component.
- [ ] Use the system design mock rubric once.

Checkpoint self-assessment

- [ ] Do you clarify scope before choosing components?
- [ ] Can you trace one request end to end?

DECISION RULE

If structure is weak, repeat the same prompt; if depth is weak, vary the bottleneck.

W08 WEEKLY FLIGHT PLAN

Data, scale, and failure

Vault route

VIDEO	sysdesign_database-replication_01.mp4
VIDEO	sysdesign_database-sharding_01.mp4
VIDEO	sysdesign_message-queues_01.mp4
VIDEO	sysdesign_consistent-hashing_01.mp4
PDF	sysdesign_database-sharding-tradeoff-matrix.pdf

Practice targets

- [ ] Write two designs centered on data growth and failure recovery.
- [ ] Estimate traffic, storage, and bandwidth for both.
- [ ] Run one failure-mode drill: dependency slow, region down, or hot partition.

Checkpoint self-assessment

- [ ] Can you explain the consistency consequence of your data choice?
- [ ] Can you identify the first scaling limit quantitatively?

DECISION RULE

Do not add components unless a stated requirement or bottleneck justifies them.

W09 WEEKLY FLIGHT PLAN

Applied system designs

Vault route

VIDEO	sysdesign_url-shortener_01.mp4
VIDEO	sysdesign_chat-system_01.mp4
VIDEO	sysdesign_notification-system_01.mp4
PDF	sysdesign_url-shortener-walkthrough.pdf
PDF	sysdesign_chat-system-walkthrough.pdf
PDF	sysdesign_notification-system-walkthrough.pdf

Practice targets

- [ ] Complete three 45-minute applied designs.
- [ ] For each, answer two follow-up pivots without redrawing from scratch.
- [ ] Run one timed system design mock.

Checkpoint self-assessment

- [ ] Can you preserve a coherent design while requirements change?
- [ ] Do you communicate tradeoffs before naming technologies?

DECISION RULE

Choose the next company-specific design based on the weakest applied archetype.

W10 WEEKLY FLIGHT PLAN

Behavioral evidence and US-context translation

Vault route

VIDEO	behavioral_star-method_01.mp4
VIDEO	behavioral_indian-context-for-us-interviewers_01.mp4
PDF	behavioral_star-template.pdf
PDF	behavioral_question-bank.pdf
PDF	behavioral_translate-indian-titles.pdf
TEMPLATE	template_behavioral-story-bank.docx

Practice targets

- [ ] Build eight distinct STAR stories mapped to 12 competencies.
- [ ] Record six answers and remove setup that does not change the listener's understanding.
- [ ] Prepare a 90-second role, company, and scope explanation.

Checkpoint self-assessment

- [ ] Does every story make your action separable from the team's?
- [ ] Can a US interviewer calibrate scope without inflated title translation?

DECISION RULE

Replace vague stories with evidence; do not add more adjectives.

W11 WEEKLY FLIGHT PLAN

Company calibration and complete loops

Vault route

PDF	company_master-index.pdf
PDF	operations_interview-day.pdf
PDF	operations_post-interview-debrief.pdf
TEMPLATE	template_recruiter-screen-notes.docx

Practice targets

- [ ] Select only evidence-approved banks for two target companies.
- [ ] Run two full interview loops on separate days.
- [ ] Repair misses within 24 hours and repeat only the failed segments.

Checkpoint self-assessment

- [ ] Are two consecutive mock loops at or near the target threshold?
- [ ] Can you adapt examples to company emphasis without memorizing alleged questions?

DECISION RULE

Drop any company bank that lacks adequate public evidence; never substitute generic padding.

W12 WEEKLY FLIGHT PLAN

Stabilize, apply, and protect interview performance

Vault route

PDF	behavioral_final-review.pdf
PDF	operations_interview-day.pdf
PDF	remote_contract-red-flags.pdf
TEMPLATE	template_interview-availability.docx
TEMPLATE	template_thank-you.docx

Practice targets

- [ ] Re-solve the top 12 errors from a blank editor.
- [ ] Run one final full loop, then reduce volume for 48 hours.
- [ ] Confirm logistics, time zones, equipment, role scope, and contract model questions.

Checkpoint self-assessment

- [ ] Is performance stable across coding, design, and behavioral rounds?
- [ ] Can you recover verbally when stuck instead of going silent?

DECISION RULE

Use the final week to stabilize proven skills, not chase novel hard problems.

END COMPLETION GATE

Evidence to leave with

- [ ] 75 new DSA problems plus spaced re-solves
- [ ] At least 10 system design write-ups
- [ ] At least six timed mocks across interview types
- [ ] Eight reusable behavioral stories
- [ ] Two target-company calibration passes using evidence-approved banks

Upgrade ladder

AI Prep / INR 1,999-2,999

+ Paid AI mock-interview practice with repeatable feedback loops

+ Use when repetition and feedback are the bottleneck.

1:1 Premium / INR 9,999-14,999

+ Capacity-limited human coaching for persistent or high-stakes gaps

+ Use when a repaired, specific gap persists or stakes are unusually high.

GUARDRAIL

A purchase is not a readiness signal. Improved performance on repaired mocks is.

Human review required

Verify workload realism, asset availability, tier pricing, upgrade wording, and every cross-reference before publishing.